

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 61 Summary

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In this lesson, Paul explains the subtle but important differences between *ir*, *irse*, and *salir*. These verbs all relate to movement or leaving in Spanish, but they are used in different contexts depending on the focus — whether it's going somewhere, leaving a place, or exiting with an emphasis on the departure point. Through personal anecdotes and clear examples, Paul breaks down each verb, explains when to use it, and highlights regional preferences and patterns. This lesson is essential for anyone looking to improve their fluency and avoid one of the most common mistakes English speakers make in Spanish.

Lesson Summary: Ir, Irse, and Salir

1. Background Context

Paul shares a story from his time as a sheriff, explaining how he used to say *Estoy saliendo* when leaving a location, only to be corrected by a native speaker who pointed out that *Me voy* is the more natural choice. This sets the stage for the lesson.

2. Ir and Irse

- *Ir* means “to go,” with the focus on the **destination**.
 - Example: *Voy a la tienda*. – I’m going to the store.
- *Irse* is the pronominal form and means “to leave” or “to head out,” with the focus on **departure**.
 - Example: *Me voy*. – I’m leaving / I’m heading out.

Important Note: When conjugating *irse*, match the reflexive pronoun to the subject: *me voy, te vas, se va, nos vamos, se van*

3. Irse + Location

While *irse* typically emphasizes leaving, it can still be paired with a location:

- *María se fue a Estados Unidos*. – María headed out to the U.S.
 - The sentence focuses on the departure, not arrival.

Command Forms:

- *Vete.* – Go away (informal)
 - *Váyase.* – Go away (formal)
 - *No te vayas.* – Don't go (informal)
 - *No se vaya.* – Don't go (formal)
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4. *Salir*

Salir translates as “to leave,” “to go out,” or “to exit.” Its uses include:

a. Departing a Place (focus on the origin)

- *¿A qué hora sale el tren?* – What time does the train leave?
- *Salgo de la casa a las ocho.* – I leave the house at eight.

b. *Salir a + Infinitive* = to go out to do something

- *¿Quieres salir a cenar?* – Do you want to go out to eat dinner?

c. Dating / Social Outings

- *Salir con alguien* = to go out with someone / to be dating
 - *Mi ex sale con mi mejor amigo.* – My ex is going out with my best friend.
 - *¿Cuánto tiempo llevan saliendo?* – How long have they been dating?

d. Media / Publication Releases

- *La nueva película sale en junio.* – The new movie comes out in June.

e. Outcomes or Results

- *El informe salió mejor de lo esperado.* – The report turned out better than expected.
- *El examen me salió difícil.* – The exam turned out to be difficult for me.
- *¿Cómo te salió la entrevista?* – How did the interview go for you?

In these, use **indirect object pronouns** to indicate whom the result affects:
me salió bien, te salió mal, etc.

Conclusion:

This lesson clears up the confusion many English speakers have when translating “to leave” or “to go” in Spanish. While *ir*, *irse*, and *salir* can appear similar, the meaning shifts depending on the focus: *ir* centers on the destination, *irse* emphasizes departure or

heading out, and *salir* highlights the act of exiting or how something turns out. Mastering the use of these three verbs will help learners sound more natural and avoid one of the most common errors in Spanish conversations.